

Seawall height in Lantana

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

LANTANA · PALM BEACH COUNTY

No minimum set in local code

Lantana sets no seawall height. Its waterway rules only fix the bulkhead line on Lake Worth.

The detail

MINIMUM	None set
BULKHEAD LINE	Adopted by map; no building beyond it - Ch. 5 Art. IV, Sec. 5-51 to 5-53
SETBACK	20 ft from the high-water line or existing seawall, whichever is greater, on lots bordering Lake Worth, plus 3 ft per story above two stories - Sec. 23-81(b)
FLOODPLAIN	Seawalls listed as other development, no elevation - Sec. 6-101
BULKHEAD MAP	R-56-008 (October 1956, amended 27 June 1966). No filling beyond it since 10 Nov 1958, and each day unlawful fill remains is a separate offense - Sec. 5-51, 5-53
ARTIFICIAL TURF	Next to a seawall, turf must be pinned or staked behind the wall; nothing may be attached to or placed on the seawall or cap - Sec. 10.5-23

Where this comes from: Town of Lantana Code, Ch. 5 Beaches, Boats, Waterways, Art. IV (Secs. 5-51 to 5-53); Ch. 23 Sec. 23-81; Ch. 10.5 Sec. 10.5-23

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3

Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4

Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.